preparation of democratic citizen' (2005, p. 51). The state failed to develop a clear understanding of the other, legal side of citizenship relating to rights, duties and political participation. This was not helped by thirty-plus years of military rule, where issues of citizens' rights were put on the back burner and political participation was restricted.

Citizenship in Pakistan

The issue of rights is particularly relevant for postcolonial societies such as Pakistan which are made up of various groups and whose state has the challenge not only of defining an overarching national identity, but also of fostering a concept of citizenship shared across various groups. Research has shown that in Pakistan, the overarching identity of being a Pakistani is often secondary to one or more ethnic, linguistic and religious/sectarian identities of the individual (see Lall 2012; Siddiqi 2010; Rahman 1998; Hussain 1976). This may be due partly to the fact that the new idea of Pakistan is in a way embattled with the regional identities that preceded the idea of Pakistan, the ethno-nationalists mentioned earlier. This becomes a problem when the state imposes a homogenous religious identity of being 'Pakistani'. Early leaders had expected that Islam would bind the new nation together and that previous fault lines would evaporate. The success of building the link between individuals and the state depends largely on how well the elites of a country have managed politically and through education to foster a common understanding of citizenship that goes beyond identity. However, as Pakistani political economist Akbar Zaidi has argued, in Pakistan the elites looked to the West, abandoning their country to be steered by those who had their own political and religious motivations.[7] As the state increasingly failed to provide the basics for ordinary Pakistanis, the rich either left or were able to buy what they needed from a parallel private sector world; this dynamic insulated the wealthy and their families from wider society. Given that elites are also those who make up the leadership of most political parties, the seeds for a disjuncture between the state and society had been sown.

Post-9/11 Pakistan

A major turning point in Pakistani politics was the terrorist attacks in the United States on 11 September 2001. General Musharraf, at the time in power, decided to stand with the United States in the 'war against terror', taking Pakistan into both an external war and an internal conflict. It is in these years that the seeds of